rose towards the skirt of Chaupāra. Babur sent out his foragers into the hills and destroyed the ‘Īsa-khail sanger. In return, they carried booty in the form of sheep, herds, and clothes.

But things were not going to remain so easy for Babur. That very night, the people of ‘Īsa-khail attacked him, however, unsuccessfully. Babur’s men had kept a good watch and their brisk reaction was almost natural. So cautious were Babur’s men that, their right, left and centre van had been aptly stationed where the tribesmen had dismounted. Each man of Babur was in accord with his generic place in battle. Each was prepared for his post—with men on foot all around the camp, at an arrow’s distance from the tents. Each night Babur ensured that his army was organized. Three or four households patrolled in turn with torches. Babur too made such rounds once each night. He ensured hefty punishments for those who didn’t fulfil their duty of being at their assigned posts holistically. He got their noses slit and then were taken through the army.

Jahāngīr Mīrzā was given the responsibility of taking care of the right wing, with the supervision of Bāqī Chaghānīānī, Sherīm ṯaghāī, Sayyid Ḥusain Akbar, and a few other begs. The left wing’s responsibility was given to Mīrzā Khān with the supervision of ‘Abdu’r-razzāq Mīrzā, Qāsīm Beg and a few other begs. The centre was occupied by not many great begs but typical household begs. Lord of the Gate Sayyid Qāsim was the van with Bābā Aūghūlī, Allāh-bīrdī and some other begs. The army had six divisions and each one had its unique day and night on guard.

Marching from that foothills they faced west. They dismounted somewhere between Bannū and the plain. The place lacked water. The soldiers had to fetch water for themselves and their herds by digging deep for a couple of yards into the dried watercourse. Babur has taken this opportunity to talk about the peculiarity of the rivers of Hindustan. He has said, ‘Not here only did this happen, for all the rivers of Hindustan have the peculiarity that water is safe to be found by digging down from one to one-and-a-half yards in their beds. It is a wonderful provision of Allah that where, except for the great rivers, there are no running waters, water should be so placed within reach in dry watercourses.’[*]

Babur and his men left the dry channel the next morning. Some of his men, riding light, reached villages of the plain in the afternoon. They raided a few of them and brought back flocks, cloth and horses bred for trade. The pack animals, camels and the warriors accompanying them, who were outdistanced due to their ultra-slow pace, kept coming into camp all through that night, till that morrow’s noon.